

NTANDOMODS ICT DIPLOMA

MONTH 2

Microsoft Word

Document Creation, Formatting & Professional Letters

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Introduction to Microsoft Word

Microsoft Word is the world's most popular word processing software. It is used to create letters, reports, CVs, memos, and any other text document. In Zimbabwe, almost every office uses Microsoft Word. Mastering it is essential for any job.

This month you will learn to create, format, save, and print professional documents from scratch.

Learning Outcomes

- Open Microsoft Word and understand the interface
- Create, save, and open documents
- Format text: fonts, sizes, bold, italic, underline, colours
- Use paragraphs, alignment, line spacing, and indents
- Insert images, tables, and page numbers
- Use headers, footers, and page breaks
- Create professional letters and reports
- Use spelling and grammar check
- Print documents correctly

Unit 1: Getting Started with Word

1.1 Opening Microsoft Word

1. Click the Start menu
2. Type 'Word' in the search bar
3. Click on Microsoft Word
4. Select 'Blank document' to start a new file

1.2 The Word Interface

Element	What it Does
Title Bar	Shows the name of your document at the top
Ribbon	The toolbar with tabs like Home, Insert, Layout, etc.
Home Tab	Font, paragraph formatting, styles, clipboard
Insert Tab	Add pictures, tables, headers, page numbers
Document Area	The white page where you type your text
Status Bar	Bottom of screen - page number, word count, zoom
Ruler	Shows margins and tab stops (top of document area)

1.3 Saving Your Work

RULE: Save your work every few minutes. If the power goes out, you lose everything that was not saved.

Save (Ctrl + S)

1. Click File > Save As (first time) or Save (after first save)
2. Choose a location (Documents folder is best)
3. Type a clear file name like 'Letter_to_Employer_June2026'
4. Click Save

File Formats

- .docx - the default Word format (always use this)

- .pdf - for sharing documents that should not be edited
- .doc - older Word format (avoid unless asked)

Unit 2: Text Formatting

2.1 Basic Formatting

Format	Shortcut	Use
Bold	Ctrl + B	Headings, emphasis
Italic	Ctrl + I	Book titles, foreign words
Underline	Ctrl + U	Important text, links
Font Size	Home tab	Normal text: 11-12pt, Headings: 14-18pt
Font Colour	Home tab	Black for normal, others for emphasis
Highlight	Home tab	Mark important sections

2.2 Paragraph Formatting

- Alignment: Left (default), Centre, Right, Justify
- Line Spacing: 1.0 (single), 1.5, 2.0 (double) - use 1.5 for most documents
- Indents: First line indent for paragraphs, hanging indent for bibliographies
- Spacing Before/After: Adds space between paragraphs without pressing Enter twice

2.3 Recommended Fonts for Professional Documents

Font	Type	Best For
Arial	Sans-serif	Business letters, reports
Times New Roman	Serif	Academic documents, formal letters
Calibri	Sans-serif	General use (Word default)

Verdana	Sans-serif	Easy to read on screen
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Unit 3: Working with Tables and Images

3.1 Inserting a Table

1. Click where you want the table
2. Go to Insert tab > Table
3. Select the number of rows and columns you need
4. Click to insert

Table Tips

- To add a row: click in the last cell and press Tab
- To delete a row: right-click > Delete Rows
- To resize columns: drag the column border
- To shade a header row: select the row, go to Table Design tab, choose a colour

3.2 Inserting an Image

1. Click where you want the image
2. Go to Insert tab > Pictures
3. Choose 'This Device' to find a photo on your computer
4. Select the photo and click Insert
5. Resize by dragging the corner handles (hold Shift to keep proportions)

3.3 Headers, Footers, and Page Numbers

1. Go to Insert tab > Header (or Footer or Page Number)
2. Choose a built-in style or select 'Edit Header'
3. Type your header text (e.g. company name, document title)
4. Click 'Close Header and Footer' when done

Unit 4: Creating Professional Documents

4.1 Writing a Business Letter

A business letter follows a standard format. Here is the structure:

1. Your address (top right)
2. Date
3. Recipient's name, title, and address (left side)
4. Greeting (Dear Mr/Mrs/Ms...)
5. Subject line (bold, underlined)
6. Body paragraphs (state your purpose clearly)
7. Closing (Yours faithfully / Yours sincerely)
8. Your name and signature

Important Rules

- Use 'Yours faithfully' when you do not know the person's name (Dear Sir/Madam)
- Use 'Yours sincerely' when you know their name (Dear Mr Moyo)
- Keep the letter to one page if possible
- Use formal language - no slang, no abbreviations

4.2 Writing a CV (Curriculum Vitae)

A CV is a document that lists your skills, experience, and education to help you get a job. Every employer will ask for one.

CV Structure

1. Full Name and Contact Details (phone, email, address)
2. Personal Profile - 2-3 sentences about yourself
3. Education - most recent first
4. Work Experience - most recent first

5. Skills - computer skills, languages, driving licence
6. References - 2 people who can speak about your character

4.3 Spelling and Grammar Check

- Press F7 to run a spelling and grammar check
- Right-click any word with a red underline to see corrections
- Green/blue underlines indicate grammar issues
- NEVER submit a document without checking spelling first

Month 2 Assessment

Theory (30 marks)

1. Name 4 tabs on the Word Ribbon and describe what each one is for. (8 marks)
2. What is the keyboard shortcut for Bold, Italic, and Save? (6 marks)
3. What is the difference between Save and Save As? (4 marks)
4. Describe the correct format for a business letter. (8 marks)
5. What font size and type would you use for a professional report? (4 marks)

Practical (70 marks)

1. Create a business letter to a fictional employer applying for a job. Must include all 8 parts of a letter, proper formatting, and no spelling errors. (25 marks)
2. Create a one-page CV for yourself with all sections listed above. (25 marks)
3. Create a document with a table (5 rows x 4 columns) showing a weekly schedule. Add headers, colours, and borders. (10 marks)
4. Insert an image into a document, resize it, and add a caption below it. (10 marks)

Pass Mark: 60%